

Stakeholder Analysis

Finding the people who decide whether the work succeeds — before they find you.

What we will cover

01 Find them all

02 Rank them

03 Who decides what

04 Goals, fears, success

05 The real decision maker

06 Who hears what

07 Trust, and escalation

08 The programme map

Harbourline Logistics — replacing a 14-year-old warehouse system

THE PROGRAMME

Harbourline Logistics: contract logistics, 1,400 staff, three warehouses — Tilbury, Daventry, Warrington. Sixty customers.

A programme to replace the warehouse management system across all three sites. Budget £6.8m, released in tranches by the transformation office against milestones.

Your firm is the systems integrator. The software vendor was chosen by the chief transformation officer, in a selection the COO did not take part in.

ONE CUSTOMER, Brightwave Retail, is 22% of revenue, served entirely from Daventry, with penalties for missed dispatch windows. Their contract renews in month 14. The Daventry cutover is planned for month 11.

The workforce is unionised. The consultation forum must be consulted on changes to working practices, and a formal consultation takes 30 days.

The external auditor has flagged the age of the system two years running.

THE PEOPLE

Helen Marsh — chief executive; board sponsor.

Raj Patel — chief transformation officer. Owns the £6.8m portfolio; chose the vendor.

Tom Brennan — COO. Runs the three warehouses; the site managers report to him.

Priya Nair — head of finance. Chairs the investment board that releases tranches.

Fiona Wallace — CIO. Her team supports the old system; both support staff retire within two years.

Aisha Khan — data-protection officer.

Gary Steadman — Daventry manager, 14 years. Brightwave phones him directly.

Louise Farrell — Tilbury manager, 11 years.

Marcus Doyle — shift supervisor, Warrington. Not a named role on the org chart.

Jean Mackie — union representative. · Nadia Hussain — Brightwave supply-chain director.

The Stakeholder Register

1 Who name · role · ring · SOURCE	2 Rank quadrant · P/L/U · influences	3 Rights R/A/C/I · confirmed or assumed	4 Wants goal · fear · success · interest	5 Buyer E/U/T/C · evidence	6 Comms now → wanted · what · how often · owner	7 Trust weak term · escalation path
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HOW TO USE IT

Copy the seven headings into your notebook now, one row per stakeholder. Each chapter fills the next column, so you finish with a working map instead of eight disconnected ideas.

Two rules that never change: a name with no SOURCE is a rumour, and a column left empty is an assumption you have not yet gone and checked.

The drills build it on the Harbourline programme. Afterwards you open one for the engagement you are actually on — that is what this session is for.

01

Find them all

Walk the onion rings and open the register — so nobody is discovered in month six.

- 01** Find them all
- 02 Rank them
- 03 Who decides what
- 04 Goals, fears, success
- 05 The real decision maker
- 06 Who hears what
- 07 Trust, and escalation
- 08 The programme map

Onion model and the Stakeholder Register

Onion model: Ian Alexander, "A Taxonomy of Stakeholders" (2005). Register: PMBOK Guide, Project Management Institute. Walk the rings from the inside out; write one row per name, with where the name came from.

1

Ring 1 — the system

The product and the team building it: developers, testers, the vendor. You already have these.

2

Ring 2 — the operators

Who uses it daily, and who runs it at night: pickers, agents, the support desk, on-call.

3

Ring 3 — the organisation

Who pays, and who can stop it: sponsor, budget holder, security, compliance, audit, staff forum.

4

Ring 4 — the environment

Outside the walls: customers, regulators, auditors, partners, whoever receives a file.

HOW IT SHOWS UP IN THIS CHAPTER

The five discovery questions walk the rings: who pays · who uses · who operates · who is affected · who can stop it. Ask the fifth one of every person you meet — each answer is a new row in the register.

WORKED IN ONE LINE — an online store's order-management replacement kicked off with six names, all of them IT. Walking the rings found nineteen, and thirteen of the new ones could delay it: the pickers, the staff forum, the payments provider, the card scheme, the carrier who owns the label format.

THE RULE — Remember the name: Onion model and the Stakeholder Register.

The invite list against the onion-walked list

BEFORE — THE KICK-OFF INVITE, AN ONLINE STORE REPLACING ITS ORDER-MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

1. Head of IT (sponsor)
2. IT project manager
3. Order-management system administrator
4. Database team lead
5. Integration developer
6. Vendor account manager

Six names. Every one of them sits in ring 1. Not one of them picks an order, answers a customer, pays for the system, or has the power to stop it.

AFTER — THE SAME PROGRAMME, WALKED RING BY RING

RING 2 — the fulfilment team lead; two pickers; customer-service agents; the support desk; the on-call engineer.

RING 3 — the CFO; the head of fulfilment; the security lead; the data-protection officer; internal audit; procurement; the staff forum (shift patterns are consulted).

RING 4 — the payments provider; the card scheme (authentication rules); the delivery carrier (label format); the tax authority (VAT filing); the external auditor.

Nineteen names. Thirteen of them can delay or stop the programme, and none of them is hostile — they were simply not invited.

THE RULE — The people who can stop you are almost never on the invite. Walk the rings, and write down where every name came from.

Who is missing from this list?

THE TRANSFORMATION OFFICE'S STAKEHOLDER LIST FOR THE HARBOURLINE PROGRAMME

1. Raj Patel — chief transformation officer, sponsor
2. Sam Okafor — head of the transformation office
3. Fiona Wallace — CIO
4. Tom Brennan — COO
5. Priya Nair — head of finance
6. Gary Steadman — Daventry manager
7. Louise Farrell — Tilbury manager
8. Lattice Systems account director — vendor
9. Systems integrator engagement lead — you
10. Solution architect
11. Data migration lead
12. Test manager

Read the list for its SHAPE, not its names: all head-office, all day-shift, all internal, all three sites represented by two of them. Whatever kind of person is absent is where the risk sits.

ONE DONE FOR YOU — USE IT AS THE TEMPLATE

MISSING — Marcus Doyle, shift supervisor at Warrington.

RING — 2, the operators. QUESTION — "who runs it at night?"

COULD STOP — nothing formally. But the COO says he is the only person who understands the pick logic, and no site can cut over without it.

DO THIS

- 1 Find five stakeholders who are missing from this list.
- 2 For each, write the onion ring and the question that finds them.
- 3 For each, write what they could delay or stop.
- 4 Mark the two you would go and meet first.
- 5 Work in pairs.

Answers on the next slide.

Who is missing — model answers

Missing	Ring	The question that finds them	Could delay or stop
Marcus Doyle, Warrington shift supervisor	2	Who runs it at night?	Named by the COO as the only person who understands the pick logic
Jean Mackie, union representative	3	Who can stop it?	Changes to working practices need a 30-day consultation — before design, not after
Nadia Hussain, Brightwave supply-chain director	4	Who is affected without touching it?	22% of revenue, renewing in month 14, served from the site that cuts over in month 11
The external auditor	4	Who is affected without touching it?	Has flagged the system two years running — the reason the board funded this
Health and safety officer	3	Who can stop it?	Scanner mounting and vehicle use need sign-off before any site goes live
The carrier whose labels are scanned	4	Who is affected without touching it?	A label-format mismatch means nothing scans on day one

02

Rank them

Power, interest, legitimacy, urgency, influence. Four quadrants, one strategy each.

01 Find them all

02 Rank them

03 Who decides what

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Power–Interest grid and the Salience model

Grid: Mendelow (1991). Salience: Mitchell, Agle & Wood, Academy of Management Review (1997). Influence is power exercised through somebody else.

1

Power

Can they make it happen — or stop it?
Budget, veto, headcount, the ear of the board.

2

Interest

How much does the outcome change their day? High interest reads everything; low interest reads the subject line.

3

Legitimacy + urgency

Salience adds two. A staff forum has little power, full legitimacy and — inside its consultation window — urgency. Two of the three and you act.

4

Influence

The finance director decides after the FP&A lead has seen the numbers. Neither has the other's authority. Record it as its own column.

HOW IT SHOWS UP IN THIS CHAPTER

Four strategies: manage closely · keep satisfied · keep informed · monitor. No more than four people in "manage closely" — you cannot manage nineteen, and trying is how programmes die of meetings.

Two questions find influence in any organisation: "when they decide something like this, who do they usually talk to first?" and "who prepares their papers?"

THE RULE — Remember the name: Power–Interest grid and the Salience model.

Nineteen names, ranked

BEFORE — EVERYONE IS IMPORTANT

MANAGE CLOSELY — head of IT, CFO, head of fulfilment, fulfilment team lead, security lead, DPO, staff forum rep, internal audit, the payments provider, the vendor, two pickers, the PM... fourteen of nineteen.

KEEP INFORMED — customer-service agents, the support desk.

MONITOR — the carrier, the tax authority, the external auditor.

The result is a weekly meeting with fourteen people. The staff forum rep, whose 30-day consultation window opened last week, gets exactly the same treatment as the vendor.

AFTER — FOUR IN THE TOP-RIGHT, ONE FLAG, ONE PATH

MANAGE CLOSELY (4) — head of fulfilment (owns the process), CFO (budget), head of IT (sponsor), security lead (review gate).

KEEP SATISFIED — internal audit, the payments provider, the DPO: one clean page a month, no surprises.

KEEP INFORMED — fulfilment team lead and pickers, agents, support desk: a fortnightly working session.

MONITOR — the carrier, the tax authority, the auditor, the vendor.

SALIENCE FLAG — the staff forum rep: low power, full legitimacy, urgent. Meet this week, whatever the quadrant says.

INFLUENCE — the CFO signs after the FP&A lead has seen the numbers. Walk him through it first.

THE RULE — Four people in "manage closely". Everyone else gets a strategy, not a meeting. Urgency overrides the quadrant.

Rank eight, flag one, find the path

EIGHT OF THE HARBOURLINE STAKEHOLDERS

HELEN MARSH — chief executive, board sponsor. Attends steering quarterly.

RAJ PATEL — owns the £6.8m portfolio and chose the vendor. Wants weekly updates.

TOM BRENNAN — COO. Runs all three warehouses. Did not choose the vendor, and says so.

PRIYA NAIR — head of finance. Chairs the board that releases each tranche of the £6.8m.

GARY STEADMAN — Daventry manager. Brightwave phones him directly.

JEAN MACKIE — union rep. Changes to working practices need a 30-day consultation, and the design freeze is near.

NADIA HUSSAIN — Brightwave. 22% of revenue. Did not know the programme existed.

MARCUS DOYLE — Warrington shift supervisor. Understands the pick logic; not on the org chart.

Two things people said in discovery: "Priya will not release tranche two without a design Fiona and Tom have both signed." · "Tom asks Gary whether the floor will wear it before he agrees to anything."

ONE DONE FOR YOU — USE IT AS THE TEMPLATE

HELEN MARSH — keep satisfied. High power (board sponsor), low day-to-day interest (quarterly).

STRATEGY — one page a quarter through the steering paper; she hears bad news before the board does, never after.

DO THIS

- 1 Put each of the eight in a quadrant. No more than four in "manage closely".
- 2 Flag the one whose salience overrides their quadrant, and say why.
- 3 Using the two quotes, write the order of conversations that gets tranche two released.
- 4 Work in pairs.

Answers on the next slide.

Rank eight — model answers

Quadrant	Who	Why
MANAGE CLOSELY (4)	Raj Patel · Tom Brennan · Priya Nair · Gary Steadman	Raj holds the money and the vendor; Tom can refuse the design; Priya releases each tranche; Gary owns the site that carries 22% of revenue.
KEEP SATISFIED	Helen Marsh · Nadia Hussain	High power, low routine interest. Helen: one page a quarter. Nadia: told the cutover date the day it is known, never the week before.
KEEP INFORMED	Marcus Doyle	No formal power and the knowledge everything depends on. A fortnightly working session, and he is in the room for the pick-logic design.
SALIENCE FLAG	Jean Mackie	Power $\times$ legitimacy $\checkmark$ (formal consultation right) · urgency $\checkmark$ (30 days, and the design freeze is near) = act this week. Start the consultation before the design lands, not after.
INFLUENCE PATH	Gary $\rightarrow$ Tom, and Fiona + Tom $\rightarrow$ Priya	Tom will not sign until Gary is comfortable; Priya will not release tranche two without Fiona and Tom's signatures. So: Gary first, then Tom, with Fiona in parallel, and Priya last — by which time her condition is already met.

03

Who decides what

Who approves, who is consulted, who is merely informed — and the three faults that break it.

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RACI — and DACI for a single decision

RACI: the standard responsibility-assignment matrix, codified in PMBOK and ITIL. DACI — Driver, Approver, Contributor, Informed — from Intuit, popularised by Atlassian, for one decision at a time.

1

R — Responsible

Does the work. Can be several people.

2

A — Accountable

Owens the outcome and signs it off.
Exactly one per row. This is the decision right.

3

C — Consulted

Two-way: asked before the decision.
Every C is a meeting — keep it to three.

4

I — Informed

One-way: told afterwards. Most stakeholders belong here, and are relieved to be.

HOW IT SHOWS UP IN THIS CHAPTER

Build it per DECISION, not per person: the rows are the five or six decisions that matter — scope, go-live, budget change, contract, what the customer is told — and the columns are the stakeholders.

THE THREE FAULTS — two As: "who owns the outcome if it goes wrong?" · everyone Consulted: "is that really true for you, or would you rather be told?" · an A with no authority: "does anyone else need to agree? Then their name goes on it, and yours as R."

THE RULE — Remember the name: RACI.

A RACI from the org chart against one that works

BEFORE — APPROVING GO-LIVE AT THE ONLINE STORE

A — head of IT, head of fulfilment and the CFO. All three "own" it.

C — fulfilment team lead, security lead, DPO, staff forum, internal audit, the payments provider, the carrier, the vendor, the PM, two pickers. Eleven.

I — everybody else.

What happened: the CFO approved. The head of fulfilment assumed his approval covered her. The head of IT waited for the head of fulfilment. Eleven Cs produced eleven "have you consulted...?" emails. Go-live slipped five weeks and nobody had said no.

AFTER — ONE A, TWO CS

A — head of fulfilment. She owns the process the system runs; the outcome is hers.

R — the programme manager, who runs the go-live checklist.

C — the security lead (penetration-test sign-off) and the fulfilment team lead (parallel-run result). Two.

I — head of IT, CFO, DPO, staff forum, audit, the payments provider, the carrier, the vendor, the pickers: told the date and the outcome.

Agreed in week two, in writing, with the CFO saying explicitly: "yes, the head of fulfilment decides; I want to be informed." The go-live meeting took twenty minutes.

THE RULE — One A per decision. Every C is a meeting. Most people are Informed, and are glad of it.

Fault-find this RACI

FOUR HARBOURLINE DECISIONS, AS THE TRANSFORMATION OFFICE DREW THEM. EVERY ROW IS BROKEN.

CUTOVER WEEKEND, PER SITE — A: Fiona Wallace (CIO). A: Tom Brennan (COO). R: programme manager. C: site manager, test manager, data lead, Lattice, Marcus Doyle, health and safety.

RELEASE OF TRANCHE TWO — A: Raj Patel, who checks with Priya Nair before every answer. R: Sam Okafor. C: Fiona, Tom.

WHAT BRIGHTWAVE IS TOLD, AND WHEN — R: Gary Steadman. C: Tom, Raj, Helen, the account team, Lattice. (No A.)

CHANGE TO THE VENDOR CONTRACT — A: programme manager (your firm). R: procurement. C: Raj, Fiona, legal.

The three faults, as a reminder: two As · everyone is Consulted · an A with no authority.

ONE DONE FOR YOU — USE IT AS THE TEMPLATE

CUTOVER WEEKEND — FAULT: two As. When a cutover runs long, each waits for the other to call the rollback and neither does.

FIX: A = Tom Brennan (he owns the business impact); Fiona R for the technical runbook and C on the rollback trigger.

DO THIS

- 1 Name the fault in each of the four rows.
- 2 Fix the two worst: write the corrected A and R.
- 3 For the tranche row, write the exact sentence you would say to Raj.
- 4 Solo, then compare in pairs.

Answers on the next slide.

Fault-find — model answers

Row	Fault	Fix
Cutover weekend, per site	Two As — and six Cs	A = Tom Brennan. Fiona R for the runbook, C on the rollback trigger. Cs down to three: site manager, test manager, Marcus Doyle. Health and safety sign off separately, before the weekend, not during it.
Release of tranche two	An A with no authority — Raj checks with Priya every time	A = Priya Nair; Raj R. SAY: "When a tranche is released, does anyone else need to agree before you can? ... Then let us put Priya as the approver and you as the person who takes it to her — which is what already happens."
What Brightwave is told, and when	No A at all — the most expensive fault of the four	A = Tom Brennan. Gary stays R because Nadia phones him, but the COO owns what a 22%-of-revenue customer is told. The vendor comes out of the row entirely.
Change to the vendor contract	An A who cannot spend — and it is your firm, not the client	A = Raj Patel (his portfolio, his vendor). Procurement R. Never hold the A on a client's contract.

04

Goals, fears, success

Goals, fears and success; positions versus interests, and which conflicts are real.

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Empathy Map and Positions versus Interests

Empathy Map: Dave Gray, XPLANE (2009). Positions versus Interests: Fisher & Ury, "Getting to Yes", Harvard Negotiation Project (1981).

1

Says / does

Evidence only. Quotes, and behaviour in the meeting — what they asked about first, and what they never asked about at all.

2

Thinks / feels

Your inference, and marked as inference. What sits behind the quote, and what are they afraid of?

3

Goal · fear · success

Pains give the fear, gains give the goal. Then ask: "if this worked, what would be true in a year that is not true now?"

4

Position vs interest

A position is what they say they want. An interest is why. Positions collide; interests often do not.

HOW IT SHOWS UP IN THIS CHAPTER

Worked in three lines: the head of fulfilment said "no downtime", mentioned last year's outage three times, and asked who would be on call. GOAL — get through cutover without a visible failure. FEAR — a repeat, with her name on it. SUCCESS, in her own words when asked the one-year question — "nobody notices."

Ask why separately and early. Interests get shared in private; positions get defended in public.

THE RULE — Remember the name: Empathy Map and Positions versus Interests.

Two positions, two interests, one reconciliation

BEFORE — POSITIONS, ARGUED IN A ROOM

CFO: "Go-live must be in October."

Head of fulfilment: "Not before January. I will not put this through peak."

The programme manager books a meeting to align. Both restate their positions, louder. The sponsor is asked to choose. He picks October.

The head of fulfilment stops returning calls, and the November cutover happens with no fulfilment support in the room.

AFTER — INTERESTS, ASKED SEPARATELY AND EARLY

CFO — position October. INTEREST: the capital budget lapses on 5 November; unspent, it is lost and the programme becomes next year's problem.

Head of fulfilment — position January. INTEREST: November and December are peak; a cutover failure then hits the biggest customers, and she cannot staff a parallel run and a peak at once.

Neither interest is actually about the date. He needs the money COMMITTED before November; she needs the CUTOVER after peak.

Sign the licence and the hardware in October; cut over in the second week of January. Both interests met. Neither position won.

THE RULE — Positions collide. Interests usually do not. Ask each side why — separately, before either has to defend a position in front of the other.

Which of these conflicts is real?

FOUR HARBOURLINE STAKEHOLDERS, EACH WITH A STATED POSITION AND THE CONTEXT BEHIND IT

FIONA WALLACE, CIO — "It has to be cloud-hosted." Context: both of her warehouse-system support staff retire within two years, and she cannot recruit to support an on-premise system after that.

AISHA KHAN, DPO — "No employee productivity data goes to the cloud until the impact assessment is finished." Context: she carries the accountability personally. The assessment takes six weeks if the vendor answers her questions, and six months if it does not.

RAJ PATEL, chief transformation officer — "Pick-rate monitoring is live at go-live." Context: the £6.8m business case is built on productivity gains, and the investment board expects them measured from day one.

JEAN MACKIE, union representative — "No pick-rate monitoring." Context: monitoring individual output changes working practices, which needs consultation. She has said: "tell us early and we are fine; tell us late and we are not." One pair looks opposed and is not. One pair genuinely wants different things.

ONE DONE FOR YOU — USE IT AS THE TEMPLATE

CFO — POSITION: "October". INTEREST: the capital budget lapses on 5 November.

HEAD OF FULFILMENT — POSITION: "January". INTEREST: November is peak; she cannot staff a parallel run and a peak at once.

Positions collide; interests do not. Commit the spend in October, cut over in January.

DO THIS

- 1 For each of the four, write the INTEREST behind the position in one line.
- 2 Find the pair whose positions collide but whose interests do not — and write the reconciliation.
- 3 Find the pair whose interests genuinely conflict — and say what that pair needs next.
- 4 Work in pairs.

Answers on the next slide.

Which conflict is real — model answers

Stakeholder	Interest behind the position	Verdict
Fiona Wallace	A system she can still support when both her specialists have retired	POSITIONS ONLY, with Aisha Khan
Aisha Khan	Not carrying a data-protection failure personally — and an assessment that does not run for six months	Reconciliation: cloud hosting AND a finished assessment. Put the vendor's answers on a dated schedule in the contract, and the six weeks fits inside the design phase. Nobody moves position.
Raj Patel	Measured productivity gains from day one, because the £6.8m business case is built on them	REAL INTEREST CONFLICT, with Jean Mackie
Jean Mackie	Members not monitored individually without agreement — and being consulted early enough to agree	Needs a negotiated design, not a meeting: aggregate site and shift metrics at go-live, individual metrics only if the forum agrees them, and the 30-day consultation started before the design freeze. Both can have most of what they need; neither gets all of it.

05

The real decision maker

Economic, user and technical buyers. The stated decision maker is rarely the real one.

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Buying influences — Miller Heiman

Robert Miller and Stephen Heiman, "Strategic Selling" (1985). Written for complex sales; used since for any decision inside a large organisation. Four roles, always present, rarely labelled.

1

Economic buyer

Releases the money or the authority. Exactly one per decision. Often not in the room, and rarely the person who invited you.

2

User buyer

Lives with the result. Their no is slow and quiet: the system simply does not get used.

3

Technical buyer

Screens on standards — security, procurement, legal, architecture. Can say no; cannot say yes.

4

Coach

Somebody inside who tells you how the place actually works. Earned by asking how things work, never by asking for help.

HOW IT SHOWS UP IN THIS CHAPTER

THREE TESTS FOR THE ECONOMIC BUYER — whose budget line does it sit on · who has vetoed something like this before · who does the stated decider check with before saying yes. Two of the three pointing the same way is your answer.

The economic buyer is per DECISION, not per person. The same programme can have a different one for the contract, the schedule and the money — and usually does. Compare with your RACI: where the A and the economic buyer differ, you have found Chapter 3's "A with no authority".

THE RULE — Remember the name: Buying influences.

The decision that stalled for six weeks

BEFORE — THE STATED DECISION MAKER

Week 1 — the head of IT approves the store's new payments platform. The team celebrates.

Week 2 — procurement asks for a business case "for the file".

Week 3 — the head of IT says it is with finance.

Week 4 — finance says they are waiting for the COO's office.

Week 5 — the COO's chief of staff asks the head of IT what the operational risk is. He does not know.

Week 6 — nothing has moved.

The map was: head of IT = decision maker. That was the whole map.

AFTER — THREE TESTS, RUN IN WEEK ONE INSTEAD

BUDGET LINE — capital spend sits with the COO, not with IT.

VETO HISTORY — last year's warehouse-automation project was stopped by the COO's office over operational risk.

CHECKS WITH — the head of IT, asked who else needs to be comfortable, says "the COO's office will want the risk piece".

Economic buyer: the COO, through her chief of staff. Technical: the head of IT. User: the fulfilment manager, never consulted. Coach: the FP&A lead who explained how capital approvals actually run.

Week 2, to the chief of staff: "Before this reaches the COO, what would she want to see on operational risk?" One page. Approved in week 3.

THE RULE — The person who can say no is not the person who says yes. Run the three tests in week one, and write the economic buyer into the register.

Find the economic buyer

HARBOURLINE NEEDS A CHANGE TO THE VENDOR CONTRACT: LATTICE WANTS TO MOVE TWO MODULES FROM THE FIXED PRICE INTO A TIME-AND-MATERIALS SCHEDULE. YOUR FIRM RAISED IT SIX WEEKS AGO. NOTHING HAS HAPPENED.

The £6.8m sits in the transformation portfolio. Raj Patel owns that portfolio and defines the milestones each tranche is released against.

Raj ran the vendor selection and chose Lattice.

Procurement runs the tender process. The procurement lead says: "We follow the process. I do not have a view on the product, and I do not sign the money."

Fiona Wallace has cleared the architecture implications and says the modules are equivalent either way.

Eighteen months ago, on a different programme, a vendor scope change was signed by Raj after the transformation office had reviewed it.

Priya Nair chairs the investment board, which releases tranches against Raj's milestones. She has never met your firm.

Careful: this is a different decision from "which site goes first". The economic buyer is per decision.

ONE DONE FOR YOU — USE IT AS THE TEMPLATE

BUDGET LINE — capital sits with the COO. VETO HISTORY — the COO's office stopped the automation project. CHECKS WITH — "the COO's office will want the risk piece."

ECONOMIC BUYER — the COO, via her chief of staff. SENTENCE — "Before this reaches the COO, what would she want to see on operational risk?"

DO THIS

- 1 Run the three tests. Write what each one points to.
- 2 Name the economic buyer for this decision, and say what role Raj, procurement and Fiona are each playing.
- 3 Write the one sentence you would say to the procurement lead to reach the economic buyer — without telling him he is not the decision maker.
- 4 Solo, then pairs.

Answers on the next slide.

Find the economic buyer — model answers

Test	Evidence	Points to
Budget line	The £6.8m sits in the transformation portfolio, which Raj owns and whose milestones he defines	Raj Patel
Veto history	A vendor scope change on another programme was signed by Raj after transformation-office review	Raj Patel
Checks with	Procurement: "I follow the process, I do not sign the money" — which points away from procurement and back at the portfolio owner	Raj Patel
The roles	Raj: ECONOMIC buyer for this decision. Procurement: TECHNICAL buyer — a process gate that can stop it and cannot start it. Fiona: TECHNICAL buyer, already cleared. Lattice: not a buyer at all, whatever they imply.	Two of three is enough; here all three agree
The sentence, to procurement	"Before this goes to Raj, what does the transformation office usually push back on with a scope change — so we can have it answered in the paper?"	He stays the expert on his own process, and you learn the real criteria
And the contrast	For "which site goes first, and when tranche two is released", the same programme has a DIFFERENT economic buyer — you will find her in Chapter 8.	Economic buyer is per decision

06

Who hears what

Engagement levels, the communication plan, and one update for a mixed room.

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Engagement Assessment Matrix and the Communications Plan

Both from the PMBOK Guide, Project Management Institute: Project Stakeholder Management and Project Communications Management. Mixed rooms use the layered message from the presentation-skills session.

1

Engagement level

Unaware → resistant → neutral → supportive → leading. Mark where each stakeholder is and where you need them. The gap is the work.

2

One step at a time

Resistant to neutral is a different action from neutral to supportive. Make a resistant stakeholder neutral; do not try to make them a champion.

3

The communication plan

Per group: what they hear · how often · which channel · from whom. Five or six lines. Nobody gets everything, weekly.

4

Mixed rooms

One headline everyone understands, then one line each for business, technical and risk — then the ask, then stop.

HOW IT SHOWS UP IN THIS CHAPTER

Two rules cut across every row: the decider hears before the room, and bad news travels first and in person.

Resistant to neutral is Chapter 4 work: find the interest behind the position, remove the specific thing they fear, and do not ask them for support.

THE RULE — Remember the name: Engagement Assessment Matrix and the Communications Plan.

One update, three audiences

BEFORE — ONE AUDIENCE'S UPDATE, GIVEN TO THREE

In the room: the COO, the head of IT, the head of risk and two business heads. The engineer presents:

"So this month we completed the integration with the payments provider, which had some issues with token refresh, and we've moved the penetration test to the 14th because the environment wasn't ready, and the data migration dry run hit 94% match which is up from 81%, and there's a question about the carrier SLA we're working through..."

The COO: "Are we on track?"

The head of risk: "What is the test delay doing to our exposure?"

Neither question was answered.

AFTER — LAYERED, ONE LINE EACH, THEN THE ASK

HEADLINE (everyone) — "We are on track for the January cutover. One risk has moved, and I need one decision from this group."

BUSINESS (COO, business heads) — "The dry run is at 94% match, up from 81%. We need 98% by December and the plan gets there. No change to the date."

TECHNICAL (head of IT) — "Payments integration is done and the token-refresh issue is closed."

RISK (head of risk) — "The penetration test moved from the 2nd to the 14th because the environment was not ready. Exposure is unchanged, because nothing is live, and the report reaches you on the 21st — before the go-live decision."

DECISION — "The carrier wants a four-hour despatch-file SLA; we can meet eight. Either we negotiate to eight, or we fund the four-hour option at £60k. I need that decided today."

THE RULE — One headline for everyone. One line each for business, technical and risk. Then the ask. Then stop.

Write the layered update

THIS MONTH AT HARBOURLINE. THE STEERING COMMITTEE IS HELEN, RAJ, TOM, PRIYA, FIONA AND AISHA.

Tilbury build is 60% complete against a plan of 55%.

The pick-logic design was reworked with Marcus Doyle at Warrington and is now signed off by Tom.

The data-protection impact assessment is finished. Aisha has cleared cloud hosting in writing, with aggregate metrics only.

Lattice missed the interface delivery date in the contract by nine days. Recovered; no schedule impact.

The union consultation on working practices has not started. A formal consultation takes 30 days and the design freeze is in seven weeks.

Brightwave has still not been told the Daventry cutover date.

DECISION NEEDED — start the 30-day union consultation now on aggregate metrics only, or hold it until the design freeze and accept the 30 days landing on the critical path.

ONE DONE FOR YOU — USE IT AS THE TEMPLATE

HEADLINE — "On track for the January cutover. One risk has moved and I need one decision today."

RISK — "The test moved from the 2nd to the 14th; the environment was not ready. Exposure is unchanged because nothing is live, and the report reaches you before the go-live decision."

DO THIS

- 1 Write five lines: HEADLINE · BUSINESS · TECHNICAL · RISK · DECISION.
- 2 Keep it under 120 words in total.
- 3 Every number gets its comparison — 60% against what?
- 4 Read it aloud to your neighbour, who is playing the head of risk. They must be able to say what changed in exposure.

Answers on the next slide.

The layered update — model answer

Layer	Model text
HEADLINE	"We are on track for the Tilbury cutover. One risk has moved, and I need one decision from this group today."
BUSINESS	"Tilbury build is 60% complete against a plan of 55%. The pick logic was reworked with Warrington and Tom has signed it off."
TECHNICAL	"The impact assessment is complete and the DPO has cleared cloud hosting in writing, on aggregate metrics only. Lattice missed the interface date by nine days and recovered it; no schedule impact."
RISK	"The union consultation has not started. It takes 30 days, and the design freeze is in seven weeks — so if we start after the freeze, those 30 days land on the critical path. Brightwave has also not yet been told the Daventry date."
DECISION	"Start the consultation now, on aggregate metrics only — which is what the DPO has already cleared — or hold it and accept 30 days on the critical path. I need that decided today."
	117 words. Every number carries its comparison: 60% against 55%, nine days recovered, 30 days against a seven-week freeze.

07

Trust, and escalation

The Trust Equation, and the four tests before you go over someone's head.

- 01 Find them all
- 02 Rank them
- 03 Who decides what
- 04 Goals, fears, success
- 05 The real decision maker
- 06 Who hears what
- 07 Trust, and escalation**
- 08 The programme map

The Trust Equation and the four escalation tests

Trust Equation: Maister, Green and Galford, "The Trusted Advisor" (2000). The escalation matrix is standard project and service-management practice (PMBOK, ITIL) — a convention rather than a theory, so the four tests are the discipline.

1

Credibility

"I can believe what she says." Repaired with evidence — one short paper, reviewed by their own expert.

2

Reliability

"I can depend on her." Repaired with small promises kept, and by renegotiating a date before it passes.

3

Intimacy

"I can tell her things." Repaired by going first, and by visibly keeping one confidence.

4

÷ Self-orientation

The divisor. Every conversation that ends in scope lowers trust however credible you are: 22 divided by 9 is 2.4; the same person at 3 scores 8.7.

HOW IT SHOWS UP IN THIS CHAPTER

THREE HABITS FOR A LONG ENGAGEMENT — say what you will do and do it, visibly · bad news first, in person, before it is in writing · no surprises in the room, ever.

FOUR TESTS BEFORE YOU ESCALATE — is it a decision, not a grievance? · has the person who should decide been asked, in writing, with a date? · has that date passed? · does waiting cost more than the trust the escalation spends? Four yeses, then one level up, with the person copied.

THE RULE — Remember the name: The Trust Equation and the four escalation tests.

Escalating a complaint against escalating a decision

BEFORE — A GRIEVANCE, FORWARDED

Subject: Ongoing issues with the security team

"I wanted to raise that we have been trying to get the penetration test scheduled for four weeks now and the security team keep moving it. This is now impacting the timeline and frankly the level of engagement has been poor. We have chased multiple times. I think someone needs to have a word with them about prioritisation because this is putting the whole go-live at risk."

The programme director forwards it to the security lead, who reads it as an attack on his team.

The test moves again.

AFTER — A DECISION, WITH THE OTHER PARTY COPIED

Subject: DECISION NEEDED by Friday — test date, or go-live moves

DECISION NEEDED — Confirm a start date by Friday, or agree to move go-live from 12 January to 2 February.

SITUATION — Go-live needs a completed penetration test; security has one tester across three programmes.

COMPLICATION — The test has moved three times. I asked in writing on the 3rd and the 10th for a date; none has been given.

OPTIONS — (a) prioritise us for the week of the 20th; (b) fund an external tester, £14k, one week; (c) move go-live to 2 February.

RECOMMENDATION — (b): the cheapest option against a three-week slip.

WHAT I NEED FROM YOU — Choose a, b or c by Friday. The security lead is copied.

THE RULE — Escalate the decision, not the person. Copy the person. Give options with costs, and a date.

Should I escalate?

FIVE SITUATIONS AT HARBOURLINE. THE FOUR TESTS: 1 IS IT A DECISION, NOT A GRIEVANCE? · 2 HAS THE DECIDER BEEN ASKED, IN WRITING, WITH A DATE? · 3 HAS THAT DATE PASSED? · 4 DOES WAITING COST MORE THAN THE ESCALATION?

A — Lattice has missed the interface delivery date written into the contract, twice. You raised it in writing with Raj on the 3rd and the 12th. Both dates have passed with no reply.

B — Tom Brennan is "being difficult" in design sessions, pushing back on every screen.

C — Priya has not released tranche two. You mentioned it at steering last week.

D — Aisha asked for a change to the impact assessment on Monday. You asked her for clarification on Tuesday. It is Wednesday.

E — Gary told you privately that he thinks Raj "chose the vendor to make himself look good".

VERDICTS TO CHOOSE FROM — ESCALATE (say to whom, and who is copied) · ASK FIRST · WAIT · NOT AN ESCALATION.

ONE DONE FOR YOU — USE IT AS THE TEMPLATE

THE PENETRATION TEST — 1 Y (a date, or go-live moves). 2 Y (asked in writing on the 3rd and 10th). 3 Y. 4 Y (three-week slip against one awkward email).

VERDICT — Escalate to the programme director, one level up, with the security lead copied. Send it as a decision with options and costs.

DO THIS

- 1 Run the four tests on each. Write Y or N for each test.
- 2 Give the verdict.
- 3 For any ESCALATE, name who you go to — one level up only — and who is copied.
- 4 Solo.

Answers on the next slide.

Should I escalate — model answers

#	1 Decision?	2 Asked in writing, with a date?	3 Date passed?	4 Worth it?	Verdict
A	Y	Y	Y	Y	ESCALATE — to Sam Okafor or the programme director, one level up; Raj copied. Send it as a decision with options: enforce the contract term, re-plan, or accept the slip.
B	N	—	—	—	NOT AN ESCALATION. This is Chapter 4: Tom was excluded from the vendor selection. Find the interest behind the pushback. "Difficult" is not a decision.
C	Y	N	—	—	ASK FIRST. A mention at steering is not a written request with a date. Send one — and note from Chapter 3 that Priya, not Raj, is the approver.
D	Y	Y	N	—	WAIT. Chase on Friday, referencing your Tuesday note.
E	N	—	—	—	NOT AN ESCALATION — and not yours to repeat. What a stakeholder tells you privately is the intimacy term of the Trust Equation. Spend it once and you never hear anything useful again.

08

The programme map

One register, one grid, one influence map for the programme — built and defended.

- 01 Find them all
- 02 Rank them
- 03 Who decides what
- 04 Goals, fears, success
- 05 The real decision maker
- 06 Who hears what
- 07 Trust, and escalation

08 The programme map

Build the programme map

FIVE EXTRACTS FROM THE DISCOVERY INTERVIEWS — EVERYTHING ELSE YOU NEED IS THE BRIEFING YOU HAVE ALREADY SEEN

- 1 · HELEN MARSH, chief executive — Wants the system off the auditor's report by next year. Said the programme is "Raj's to run and Tom's to land". "If Brightwave walks, nothing else matters."
- 2 · RAJ PATEL — Owns the £6.8m and ran the selection. Says the COO "was invited to selection and did not engage". Wants Tilbury first. Mentioned that "Priya will not release tranche two without a design Fiona and Tom have both signed".
- 3 · TOM BRENNAN, COO — "I did not choose them. I will run whatever I am given, but I was not in the room." Wants Daventry done "properly or not at all". On the way out: "Marcus at Warrington is the only person who understands the pick logic. Nobody has asked him anything."
- 4 · GARY STEADMAN, Daventry — "Daventry goes last, after you have broken Tilbury and fixed it." Fears a missed Brightwave despatch window in month 11, penalties, and the renewal lost "on my watch".
- 5 · LOUISE FARRELL, Tilbury — "Tilbury goes first, we are ready and we are not Brightwave." Tilbury lost two customers last year to a competitor with better tracking; she needs the new system live before her own tender in month 9.

ONE DONE FOR YOU — USE IT AS THE TEMPLATE

From Chapter 2, one row of the register, done: JEAN MACKIE — keep informed by quadrant; salience flag PX L✓ U✓, so acted on this week. Strategy: start the consultation before the design freeze, on aggregate metrics.

DO THIS

- 1 Grid: place the ten people from the briefing. Four in "manage closely" at most, and flag anyone whose salience overrides their quadrant.
- 2 Economic buyer for "which site goes first, and when tranche two is released" — run the three tests and cite two.
- 3 The conflict: write Gary's and Louise's interests, not their positions. Is it real, and what is the reconciliation?
- 4 Who is missing from every list, and who is resistant — and what is the one action that moves them?
- 5 The escalation path for the site-order decision: who arbitrates, and when would you agree it?

Answers on the next slide.

The programme map — what the notes actually tell you

Judgement call	The answer, and the evidence
Economic buyer	PRIYA NAIR — not Raj. Budget line: she chairs the investment board that releases each tranche. Checks-with: Raj himself says "Priya will not release tranche two without a design Fiona and Tom have both signed" (note 2). Raj owns the portfolio on paper; the money moves only when Priya releases it. Nobody has met her. Compare with Drill 5, where the same programme's economic buyer for the vendor contract was Raj — it is per decision.
The real conflict	Gary and Louise look like a scheduling squabble and are not. Louise's interest is a tender in MONTH 9. Gary's is Brightwave's renewal in MONTH 14, with the cutover planned for month 11 — three months to recover from a bad one. Reconciliation: Tilbury first, and Daventry EARLIER than planned, around month 9 or 10, giving Brightwave four stable months before the renewal conversation. Both interests met; neither position won. "Daventry last" would have made it worse.
Missing and resistant	MISSING: Marcus Doyle, named by the COO as the only person who understands the pick logic and on no list (note 3); and Nadia Hussain, whose renewal is the chief executive's definition of success (note 1). RESISTANT: Tom Brennan — because he was excluded from the vendor selection, not because of the system (notes 2 and 3). The one action: put him in the room for the decisions he was excluded from, starting with site order, and ask him — not Raj — to name the cutover criteria.
The escalation path	It does not exist. Note 1 comes closest — "Raj's to run and Tom's to land" — which means a site-order dispute between them has no named arbiter. Agree it in week two, before it is needed: "If you two cannot agree a site order, who do you want it taken to?" The answer is Helen, and it belongs in the charter.

Eight frameworks to take home

- | | | |
|---|--|---|
| 1 | Onion model · Stakeholder Register | Alexander 2005 · PMBOK — walk the rings, one row per name, with its source |
| 2 | Power–Interest grid · Salience | Mendelow 1991 · Mitchell, Agle & Wood 1997 — four at most in "manage closely" |
| 3 | RACI · DACI | PMBOK / ITIL · Intuit — one A per decision, and every C is a meeting |
| 4 | Empathy Map · Positions vs Interests | Gray 2009 · Fisher & Ury 1981 — positions collide, interests often do not |
| 5 | Buying influences | Miller Heiman 1985 — economic, user, technical, coach; the yes is not where the no is |
| 6 | Engagement matrix · Communications plan | PMBOK — one step at a time; who hears what, how often, from whom |
| 7 | Trust Equation | Maister, Green & Galford 2000 — credibility, reliability, intimacy, over self-orientation |
| 8 | The four escalation tests | PMBOK / ITIL practice — decision? asked? date passed? worth it? Then one level up, copied |

What you can now do

- ✓ Walk the onion rings and open a register with a source against every name.
- ✓ Rank by power and interest, flag by salience, and reach a decider through the people they listen to.
- ✓ Write a RACI with one Accountable per decision, and say the sentence that fixes a broken one.
- ✓ Find the interest behind a position, and the economic buyer behind the stated decider.
- ✓ Plan who hears what, diagnose trust by term, and pass four tests before you escalate.

NEXT

Open a register for the engagement you are on now.

Column 1 first — every name, with its source.

Ask one stakeholder the fifth question: who can stop this?

Run the three tests on the decision that is currently stuck.

Agree an escalation path with somebody before you need it.